

Historical Glass Museum



June 2025 Volume 9 Issue 3

Museum Location:

1157 Orange Street
Redlands, California
909-798-0868

Mailing Address:

P. O. Box 9195
Redlands, CA 92375-2395



The Museum has a page on Facebook, for those who like to indulge in social media. Search for REDLANDS HISTORICAL GLASS MUSEUM

Keeping in Touch

Things have been on a steady pace at the Museum during the past couple of months. We had 145 visitors in March, 66 in April, and 69 in May. We were particularly busy during Memorial Day weekend.

GIFT SHOP NEWS

Sales have been strong in the Gift Shop, as we had a couple of nice donations earmarked for that purpose. These sales support our day-to-day operations.

30% SALE

There is a **30% off Sale in the gift shop** from now until the end of the July 4th weekend. Some really nice items have been added, so "come on down."

TOURS

We had one tour since the last newsletter, for 12 people from the Agura Hills Senior Center in April.

WORKSHOPS/SEMINARS

No workshops scheduled during the hot summer months.

PARKING LOT SALE

We plan to reschedule it sometime in the fall, probably after Halloween.

GENERAL MAINTENANCE

A new set of concrete steps were installed and are looking good. We also had some work done on the wrought iron fencing.

FROM THE COLLECTION



Recently featured on our facebook page, pictured above is a Fenton "Sailboats" goblet with marigold carnival treatment. It was made circa 1915. It is part of a recent EAPG donation from the Estate of Mary K. Manley.

MEMBERSHIP CORNER

We welcome the following new members:

Avriella Ford
Sandra Valle
Beatriz Reviere

STAFFING ISSUE

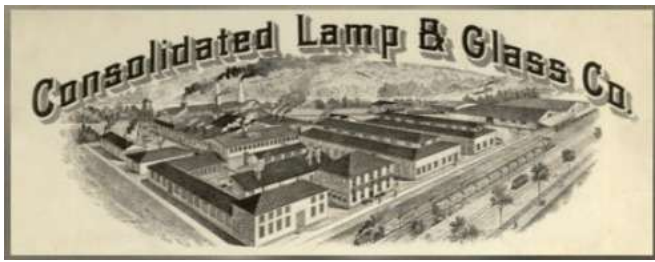
We are reluctant to keep hounding our membership about this, but the lack of volunteer staff in the Redlands area is a serious problem.

Most of our Board member live a distance from Redlands and cannot drop by the Museum in the course of their daily routine. But there are things that need local attention, such as putting out and taking in the trash cans and just checking on the status of the property. Can any local member help us with this? It wouldn't take very much time, but would really be helpful.

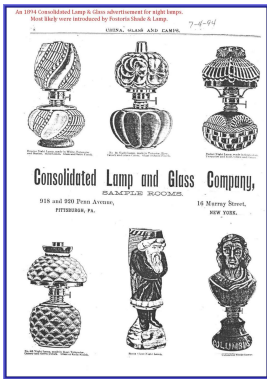
We need a Treasurer who can handle deposits from the Gift Shop and simply pay the bills as they come due. This is difficult to do for someone who lives 50-100 miles from Redlands, and is best done by a local member.

We also need a Vice President, again, hopefully from somewhere fairly close to Redlands. This position has, in the past, handled Tours and docent scheduling.

Please think about it.



The Consolidated Lamp and Glass Company started in Fostoria, Ohio in 1893 with the merger of the Fostoria Shade and Lamp Company with Wallace and McAfee Company. Two years later, they moved to Coraopolis, PA, after their glassworks in Fostoria burned down. For the decades beginning in the 1890's, they did produce some art glass vases and bowls, however, their main production was high quality lamps, globes and shades.



In 1925 Reuben Haley, a noted glass designer working at U.S. Glass Co., left them and set up his own design company in space rented from Consolidated Lamp and Glass. That same year the Paris Exposition Internationale des Arts Decoratifs et Industriels Modernes was held, and following the show in Europe, about 400 objects from this Art Deco exhibition toured several cities in the USA. This travelling exhibition included many glass items by Rene Lalique. This resulted in a demand for similar types of glass in the USA.

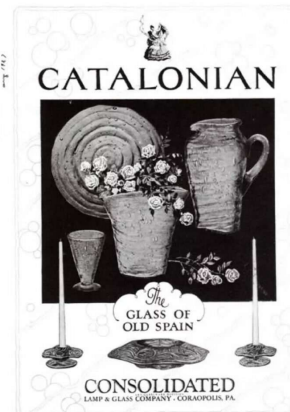


Reuben Haley encouraged Consolidated to produce glassware to his designs, some of which were direct copies of Lalique pieces (e.g. the Love Birds vase which copies Lalique's Perruches vase, and the Bird of Paradise vase which copies Lalique's Aras vase).

Consolidated produced a range of truly beautiful art glass vases which they called their Martele Hand Wrought Art Glass (examples shown below). This type of glass is highly prized by collectors today.



Also during the 1920's, Consolidated produced and marketed art glass based on old Spanish designs (which they called Catalan glass) and acid etched designs (called Florentine) amongst others.



Another Art Deco success was their bold, angular, Ruba Rombic designs shown below, introduced in 1928. Today, these designs command high prices and are highly desirable.



(continued on next page)

What about Phoenix Glass?

In 1932 the depression was seriously affecting the Consolidated glassworks, so the owners decided to close down temporarily to stop their losses. Reuben Haley had retained the rights to the moulds he had designed for them, and after he died in 1933, his son Kenneth transferred the moulds to Phoenix Glassworks where he was employed, so that the production could continue. Phoenix made these Martele designs under the name Phoenix Reuben-Line from 1933 to 1936. When Consolidated re-opened in 1936, they reclaimed their moulds and resumed production.

Phoenix also produced their own designs in a very similar kind of glass which they marketed as Sculptured glass. Below is a photo of several pieces of Phoenix glass.



NOTE: Consolidated Lamp and Glass Company and the Phoenix Glass Company were always separate companies.

Consolidated continued to produce their Martele designs until the company closed down in 1963. Until the closing, they were still producing lighting products, and many of the Martele vases were also offered as lamp bases. Following are some photos of glass items and advertising material from Consolidated's long history.



The **Amelite**

Eliminating the Difficulties of Efficient Store Lighting

Brilliant thoroughly diffused light, a fixture that is handsome yet moderate in cost. You get these in the AMELITE—a real achievement in store lighting efficiency.

It gives you all the advantages, and none of the disadvantages, of the separate bowl and reflector. One piece, no connections; readily installed. The prismatic crystal band, which diffuses the light, is a feature alone sufficient to make the AMELITE a noteworthy success.

For you the AMELITE means sales—quick, sure and certain. Its established demand assures a ready market for you.

Write for prices today

Consolidated Lamp and Glass Co.
CORAOPOLIS, PA.

NEW YORK, N. Y. 10 West Broadway	HAMILTON, ONT. 42 King St. East	PITTSBURGH, PA. 1100 Empire Bldg.
PHILADELPHIA, Pa. 104 Arch Street	CHICAGO, ILL. 17 N. Wabash Ave.	PORTLAND, ORE. 120 Sherman Bldg.
BOSTON, MASS. 104 Federal St.	CINCINNATI, OHIO 141 East 4th Street	LOS ANGELES, CAL. 347 Pacific Elec. Bldg.

The AMELITE is made in three sizes, furnished with or without fixture. For the extra large room use the 14" AMELITE.

A GLASS SHADE For Every Room in the HOUSE

DUQUESNE KITCHEN LUMINAIRE—shells clear, glassless, well-diffused rays through smoky-white Cora glass. All fixtures are concealed.

One of the fortunate circumstances that surround the selling of Consolidated Lamps is that no matter in what portion of the house your customer requires better lighting—in the kitchen or milady's boudoir—there is a style and a type especially designed for that purpose.

The decorated shades of the Consolidated line are all hand painted. Their craftsmanship is unexcelled. Consolidated Lamps sell rapidly. Their turnovers are swift and sure.

By displaying any one style of the Consolidated line, you align yourself with the Lighting Educational Committee of the campaign for eyesight conservation. "Better Home Lighting" is the slogan for this campaign—and better home lighting is made possible by a Consolidated.

CONSOLIDATED PORTABLE—for living room, library or hallway. One of the most popular styles of the Consolidated line. All shades are hand-painted.

BRACKET SHADE—for wall brackets in living room, bed room, dining room or hallway. Style 1748-948 illustrated.

BED ROOM SHADE—receding flange at bottom affords properly shaded light without reducing efficiency. Style 2401-939 illustrated.

SHOWER LIGHTS—for the main lighting fixtures of dining room. Comes in various styles and types. Style 2227-ET 471 illustrated, and is Golden Oak in color.

BED ROOM SHADE—receding flange at bottom affords properly shaded light without reducing efficiency. Style 2401-939 illustrated.

BED ROOM LUMINAIRE—decorated—used by many for bed-rooms. Hand painted in various exquisitely executed designs.

Consolidated Lamp & Glass Company
Coraopolis, Penna.

New York Boston Los Angeles Chicago Portland London, Ont.

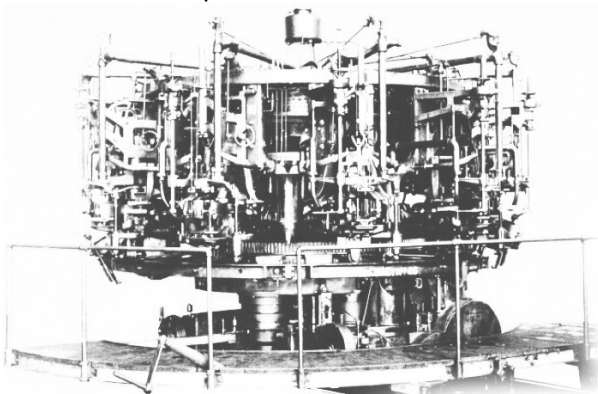
WHO WAS MIKE OWENS?

Michael Joseph Owens was one of the glass industry's most important figures. He was born in 1859 in Virginia (now a part of West Virginia). In his youth, he was employed by Hobbs, Brockunier Co., of Wheeling, W. Va., the Union Flint Glass Co., of Martins Ferry, OH, and the Libbey Glass Co., of Toledo, OH.

In 1895 Mike Owens and Edward D. Libbey organized the Toledo Glass Company, for the purpose of manufacturing glass tumblers, gas globes, lamp chimneys, etc., using a special machine which Owens had invented and patented. The United States rights were sold to the Macbeth-Evans Glass Company of Pittsburgh, Pa., and the Canadian rights sold to the Dominion Glass Company, of Montreal, Quebec.

Mike Owens' greatest achievement was his invention of the Automatic Bottle Machine, which bears his name. This mechanical marvel revolutionized the bottle-making industry. To emphasize the significance of this invention, in 1908 the Owens machine produced a total of 105,000,000 bottles, while eight years later, in 1916, the Owens Automatic Bottle Machine pumped out, 1,565,000,000 bottles in the same territory.

He became vice-president and general manager of the Owens Bottle Machine Company, and the Libbey-Owens Sheet Glass Company of Toledo, Ohio. He oversaw the construction of the bottle factory at Trafford Park, near Manchester, England. Later, he sold the Trafford Park factory and the foreign rights to a Continental European syndicate, and the machines were then operated in Germany, England, Scotland, Ireland, Mexico, and Cuba, under syndicate management, and they also expanded to South America and Japan.



Here it is – the Owens Automatic bottle-making machine

In 1915, The Franklin Institute of Philadelphia, instituted an investigation into the merits of the Owens Automatic Bottle Machine. Below is a direct quote from that report.

Besides his patents on bottle-making machines, Mr. Owens holds patents on a glass tank and also on a lehr, which latter he has made in a continuous tank form to correspond with the continuous operation of the bottle machine and to be connected to it, the whole forming a continuous bottle-making and annealing means. The inventor appears to be solely responsible for the development of the entirely automatic bottle-making machine. All others on the market are semi-automatic machines, based on the principle of the Arbogast invention. As indicated, these semi-automatic machines require the glass to be gathered by hand. One fifteen-unit Owens machine, making 250 gross of bottles per twelve hours, can be operated by one unskilled man, but to produce the same amount of ware with the semi-automatic machine requires at least eight machines and forty men, eight of whom must be skilled workmen. (Ed: emphasis mine.)

To honor his importance to everyone associated with the glass community, after his passing in 1923, the A.H. Heisey Glass Co. made a glass commemorative bust of Mike Owens, shown below.



In 1912, Owens acquired rights to [Irving Wightman Colburn](#)'s invention for manufacturing [plate glass](#). In June 1916, the Libbey-Owens Sheet Glass Company was organized. In 1928, Libbey-Owens was the first company to produce automotive [laminated safety glass](#) and won a contract to supply the [Ford Motor Company](#) with windshields for the [Model A](#). Libbey-Owens merged with the [Edward Ford Plate Glass Company](#) in 1930 to form Libbey-Owens-Ford Glass Company.

In 1929, the Owens Bottle Co. acquired the assets of Illinois Glass Co. of Alton, Illinois, and renamed itself the Owens-Illinois Glass Co., making it the largest glass company in the world at the time. [Owens-Illinois](#) Glass Company acquired Libbey Glass Company in 1935, but later spun it off as a separate company in 1993.

Group Tours of the Museum



Weekday group tours for groups of 8 or more visitors are available by appointment. The charge is \$5.00 per person, with a minimum charge of \$40.00. To schedule a group tour, visit our web site and use the "Contact Us" page to send us a request, and someone will be in touch. The phone number for the Museum is only answered on weekends when we are open.

We had one tour in May, from Agura Hill Senior Center, for 12 people. We are limited in our staff for tours, but you can still contact us and we will try to schedule you.



Don't forget – the Gift Shop is featuring a 30% off Sale until the end of the 4th of July weekend.

RESTORATION FUND

The Board of Directors established a Restoration Fund designated to set aside funds for restoration and maintenance of our century-old building.

The current balance in the fund is: **\$6,380.63.**
Donations are gratefully accepted.

DONATIONS - APRIL / MAY

Meryl and Michael McDowell \$100
Cheryl Bryan \$100
Joseph Leake \$100
Martha McGill \$100
Laurie Prill donation is monthly \$10
Robert Spivacke \$100

The Board extends a hearty Thank You to all of these folks.

JUNE 2025 FROM THE PRESIDENT:

Hello Members,

In past months I have asked for volunteers to serve occasionally as a Museum docent. This month, I would like to invite you to join us for our monthly Cleaning Day, generally held on the third Thursday of each month. The next three dates are June 19th, July 17th, and August 21st.

What do we do on Cleaning Day? Well, that depends on what needs to be done in the Museum at any given time. It could be spraying the glass doors of display cases with Windex and giving them a wipe down, vacuuming, dusting, sweeping, taking out the trash, replacing light bulbs, and any number of other little mundane tasks that keep the Museum clean and looking good for our visitors.

It's only a few hours each month, and you don't have to commit to coming every month. Experienced volunteers and Cleaning Day veterans will guide you, and you certainly don't have to do any strenuous tasks you're not able to do easily. Won't you come join us for Cleaning Day? Please email us at

HistoricalGlassMuseum4@gmail.com

to let us know you're coming. Thank you, and see you soon!

Michael

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Board Members

President: Michael Krumme

Vice President: (open)

Secretary: Michael Krumme

Treasurer: (open)

Board Member: Jan Korfmacher

Board Member: David Adams

Board Member: Andy Hoder

Board Member: Doreen Ward

Board Member: Barbara Jenks

Board Member: Kathi Jablonsky

Board Member: Monica Barragan

Board Member: William Brakemeyer

Docents

Bill Summers

Monica Barragan

Bob Crha

Jacque Rocha

Connie Wheeler

Barbara Jenks

Shirley Barnett

Stephen Barnett

Koral Ahmet

ADS FROM THE PAST

It is always interesting to see advertisements from the past. Maybe you will recognize some of the patterns or pieces from your own collection.

GIMBEL MONTH IN NEW YORK



**Gold Encrusted colored
TABLE GLASSWARE.**

At less than usual
wholesale cost **\$1.25** EACH

We purchased a manufacturer's stock of glassware at a very advantageous price. Every piece is first quality. There are sandwich trays, cheese and cracker sets, celery trays, relish dishes, candy jars, vases, bowls and candlesticks. All at one price. In amber color, green or crystal. Encrusted border is one-half inch wide.

GIMBELS CHINA SHOP—Fifth Floor.

1926 Gimbels – NY Daily News



**Amber-colored Glass
Stemware
59c**

Sparkling amber colored goblets, parfaits, ice tea, beverage glasses, tumblers, etc., with rich gold etched band borders. Charming shapes.

1926 Abraham & Strauss - Brooklyn Times-Union

Add These Toilet Goods to Home Supplies—for Less!

Glass Vanity Sets

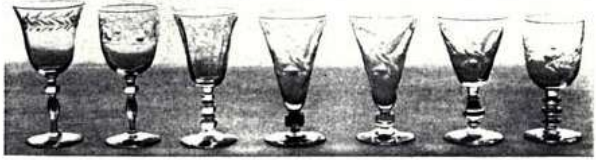


Two perfume bottles, powder jar and tray artistically painted. Alice blue, rose, amber or green. **\$1**

1928 New Martinsville – Lit Bros, Camden NJ

NOW—YOU CAN SELL BETTER STEMWARE from OUR STOCK

FINE ENGRAVED GLASSWARE BY **GLASTONBURY INC.**



CHATELAIN Engraved with beautiful scrolls combined polished and grey cutting to make a total of \$1.85.

CHATELAIN Engraved with beautiful scrolls combined polished and grey cutting to make a total of \$1.85.

ROSE Needle wheel design engraved on clear crystal with enamel color in stem. To retail at \$1.85.

BIRD OF PARADISE Engraved on clear crystal with enamel color in stem. To retail at \$1.85.

BIRD OF PARADISE Engraved on clear crystal with enamel color in stem. To retail at \$1.85.

BIRD OF PARADISE Engraved on clear crystal with enamel color in stem. To retail at \$1.85.

ELITE Engraved on clear crystal with enamel color in stem. To retail at \$1.85.

ITEMS IN STOCK
Goldets, Ice Trays, Sauce Champagne, Liqueur Cocktail, Wines, Cordials.

**BRYCE BROS. CRYSTAL GLASS
ENGRAVED BY MASTER CRAFTSMEN**

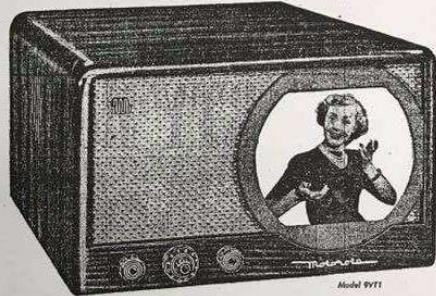
BUY SAMPLES And work our stocks at a minimum investment. You'll make big profits on every sale. 48 hour delivery.

Interesting Ad featuring Bryce Bros stemware
Engraved and sold by Glastonbury

AT DORN'S SAVE \$10 TO \$80.00
ON ALL MODELS OF
Motorola TELEVISION
NEW BROADVIEW SCREEN WITH
Giant Picture Tube!

POSITIVELY ONLY 1¢ DOWN
NO MORE MONEY FOR 40 DAYS

Full Price Only **\$136.95**
AT DORN'S SHOP AND COMPARE!



SEE and HEAR: Milton Berle • Ed Wynn • Hop-A-Long Cassidy
Football • Wrestling • Plays • Movies • News

New 1950 Broadview Picture Tube ★ Simplified Controls—Perfect Pictures Without Difficulty ★ New Hi-Voltage Circuit Gives Brighter-Than-Ever Pictures ★ Automatic Gain Control Prevents Picture Fading, Keeps Picture Values Constant ★ Automatic Brightness ★ Stunning All-Wood Mahogany Cabinet ★ Compensated Contrast

NO OUTSIDE AERIAL NEEDED
IN 8 OUT OF 10 AREAS WITH GOLDEN BEAM ANTENNA ONLY \$5.95 EXTRA

SHOP SUNDAY All Stores Open 12 NOON TO 9 P.M.

LOS ANGELES
4361 MELROSE AVE.
Two Blocks West of Vermont
RD. 2-2119

HUNTINGTON PARK
4134 PACIFIC BLVD.
Stones 9222

SOUTHWEST
8811 SO. VERMONT AVE.
(33rd and Vermont)
PL 2-1555

DOWNTOWN
929 SO. BROADWAY
(Broadway and Olympic)
TE. 2841
Free Delivery Service

GLENDALE
353 N. BRAND BLVD.
(Near California Street)
CH. 8-2205—CH. 8-2118

WAREHOUSE & OFFICE
1732 SANTEE ST.
LOS ANGELES
BL. 7-9466

DORN'S
"HOUSE OF MIRACLES"
ALL STORES OPEN 10 A.M. TO 9 P.M. DAILY

Just for fun. 1950 Advertisement